

what we have learned to get to work immediately on the next iteration.

Therefore, shortcuts taken in product quality, design, or infrastructure today may wind up slowing a company down tomorrow. You can see this paradox in action at IMVU. [Chapter 3](#) recounted how we wound up shipping a product to customers that was full of bugs, missing features, and bad design. The customers wouldn't even try that product, and so most of that work had to be thrown away. It's a good thing we didn't waste a lot of time fixing those bugs and cleaning up that early version.

However, as our learning allowed us to build products that customers did want, we faced slowdowns. Having a low-quality product can inhibit learning when the defects prevent customers from experiencing (and giving feedback on) the product's benefits. In IMVU's case, as we offered the product to more mainstream customers, they were much less forgiving than early adopters had been. Similarly, the more features we added to the product, the harder it became to add even more because of the risk that a new feature would interfere with an existing feature. The same dynamics happen in a service business, since any new rules may conflict with existing rules, and the more rules, the more possibilities for conflict.

IMVU used the techniques of this chapter to achieve scale and quality in a just-in-time fashion.

THE WISDOM OF THE FIVE WHYS

To accelerate, Lean Startups need a process that provides a natural feedback loop. When you're going too fast, you cause more problems. Adaptive processes force you to slow down and invest in preventing the kinds of problems that are currently wasting time. As those preventive efforts pay off, you naturally speed up again.

Let's return to the question of having a training program for new employees. Without a program, new employees will make mistakes while in their learning curve that will require assistance and intervention from other team members, slowing everyone down.